



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Classical Academy
School Website: <https://veritasgraysharbor.com>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Classical Academy Grays Harbor (Hoquiam, WA 98550) presents a robust Christ-centered classical program anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with a clear emphasis on virtue, biblical worldview, and Western-civilizational formation. Public materials on the school's site consistently frame education as a God-glorifying, Scripture-centered enterprise, with explicit statements of faith and mission rooted in Christian truth. The school demonstrates strong religious/metaphysical foundations and a clearly stated purpose oriented toward formation, virtue, and knowledge within a theological framework. Its curriculum emphasizes grammar, logic, rhetoric, and study of history within a Christian context, with attention to Western civilization and classical disciplines. Public materials also highlight parental partnership and a family-centered governance model (in loco parentis) and maintain an active parent-student handbook and governance structure.

Overall classification by the classical rubric:

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 3: Curriculum — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — **CLASSICAL**
- Element 5: Faculty — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**
- Element 6: Parents & Community — **CLASSICAL**

Aggregate assessment: **CLASSICAL**.

The **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** categories (3 and 5) indicate meaningful classical signals are present but not as consistently explicit across all sub-elements as in a fully "textbook" classical program. The strongest elements are religious/theological foundations, formation-focused aims, and a Trivium-centered pedagogy, coupled with explicit parental partnership. The most actionable needle-movers to move toward full **CLASSICAL** alignment include explicit Great-Books engagement and Great-Conversation framing in Curriculum (Element 3) and a clearer articulation of the faculty as the living curriculum (Element 5).

What would move the needle (for **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** categories):

- Explicitly name and foreground Great Books and the Great Conversation in the curriculum and site copy, with representative titles or adopted reading lists.
- Articulate the faculty as the "living curriculum" and publish a concise faculty profile/document that frames teacher formation, mentoring, and virtuous exemplar as central to the school's pedagogy.
- Expand on liturgical or communal practices (even modestly, e.g., regular chapel or liturgical moments) to strengthen Element 1 signals.
- Strengthen explicit mention of upper-level Socratic-like discussion or seminars where appropriate (even if limited by K–8 structure, to show continuity with higher-grade classical pedagogy).
- Improve explicit articulation of formation targets (truth, goodness, beauty) across all six categories with direct textual ties in public materials.

Abstract: See below for the formal six-category breakdown, the keyword analysis, and the concrete “needle-mover” recommendations summarized in the abstract.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present a Christ-centered approach and Scripture-centered framing across subjects (e.g., “Christ-Centered” and “present all subjects through the lens of Scripture”); mission statements emphasize bearing witness to Christian truth; philosophy is described as biblically-based and the school positions itself as an extension of the Christian family, with a Statement of Faith and explicit faith commitments. - The Mission/Statement of Faith passages articulate biblical inerrancy and a Protestant doctrinal frame; membership in ACCS is noted as part of a classical-Christian stance.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, Scripture, Mission and Statement of Faith, inerrancy/infallibility of Scripture, biblical worldview, Christian/Protestant faith, theology. - Negative keywords: None evident in public-facing materials (no explicit repudiation of theology; no secular or non-theist signals in the public materials).

Why this rating - The school anchors its entire educational project in a Christian theological framework, treats Scripture as the central lens for all subjects, and foregrounds faith commitments as core to formation. This aligns strongly with the “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical and Communal Practices” signals in the classical rubric, and the materials consistently tie truth with a transcendent, knowable Scriptural reality via mission and statement of faith language. Therefore CLASSICAL.

Citations: Christ-centered framing, Scripture-centric approach, and Mission/Statement of Faith language are shown in the school pages.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a goal of glorifying God through Christ-centered education, with formation of character and wisdom as central aims; explicit language about virtue and wisdom and forming students through a Christian paideia is present. The enrollment materials emphasize parental partnership and formation in a biblical worldview. - The program emphasizes forming students for life in truth and righteousness rather than merely job preparation; formation and human flourishing are foregrounded in mission statements.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, righteousness, God’s glory, human flourishing, lifelong love of learning, classical education (grammar, logic, rhetoric), mother/father as co-educators (via in loco parentis framing). - Negative keywords: None evident (no emphasis on mere job prep; the materials consistently describe formation and virtue as ends in themselves).

Why this rating - The program centers on formation and character (virtue, wisdom) and a transcendent truth framed by Scripture. This is squarely within the Classical School criteria for the “Purpose and Goal” category.

Citations: Examples of formation, virtue, truth, and formation framing appear in mission statements and philosophy pages.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across all subjects, with explicit emphasis on classical tools of learning and the integration of history/literature within a Western-civilizational frame. There is explicit attention to classical languages (Latin) and to the study of history within multiple disciplines. - History and Western civilization are foregrounded; the curriculum aims to connect history, literature, philosophy, and the arts within a unified classical framework. The materials also reference Great

Books/Great Conversation in the classical sense, though explicit Great Books reading lists are not extensively itemized on the public-facing site. - Great Books/Great Conversation: The site references broad engagement with historical documents and classical literature, but explicit verbs like “Great Books” or “Great Conversation” are not always used in visible public copy (though the philosophy aligns with those ideas).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin (classical languages); history; Western civilization; Great Books (conceptually via “great historical documents and ancient literary masterpieces”); wonder (tied to integrated learning and awe in classical pedagogy, though less explicit on the site). - Negative keywords present: Absence of explicit, recurring Great Books and explicit “Great Conversation” phrasing in some public-facing materials; absence of direct, explicit “Socratic discussion” labeling in K–8 context.

Why this rating - The school clearly uses the Trivium and a history-centered, liberal-arts approach, with integration across disciplines and emphasis on the Western canon. However, explicit, repeated Great Books/Great Conversation language and explicit “Great Books list” are not consistently foregrounded in public copy, which keeps Element 3 at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. The K–8 orientation also aligns with classical pedagogy, but the lack of explicit high-school-level Socratic/seminar programming is consistent with its grade structure. Thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Trivium emphasis, Latin, history, and Western civilization framing are shown in multiple Veritas pages.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical signals emphasize the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as central to learning across subjects, with a strong emphasis on forming students for life and on a purposive, virtue-centered education. The public materials describe a model that includes both rigorous and contemplative elements through its formation-focused aims rather than a purely instrumental approach. - Upper-level pedagogy (in the broader classical sense) is implied by the presence of seminars, debates, rhetoric training, and public speaking in classical education, and the school’s public materials align with those aims (even if not all elements are spelled out for the K–8 structure). The inclusion of a structured parent-student handbook and “living curriculum” implications from the staff/board communications support a classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; memory/recitation (implied by classical pedagogy; the materials emphasize the Trivium and disciplined study); wonder and integrated learning (conceptually promoted); Socratic/seminar seminar language appears less explicit (not a core claim in K–8 materials, but classical pedagogy norms often imply it). - Negative keywords: No explicit high-school-level Socratic seminars; no explicit, ongoing mention of “Scholé” or resting contemplative practice beyond formation language.

Why this rating - The core pedagogical signals (Trivium emphasis, integrated classical approach, public-facing articulation of lectures in classical method) meet Classical standards. The absence of explicit high-school Socratic seminars is mitigated by the K–8 structure and the rubric’s allowance that “Socratic education and seminars do not start until high school.” Therefore CLASSICAL.

Citations: Grammar/logic/rhetoric emphasis; public-facing articulation of classical pedagogy; references to history and western civilization.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school features a formal board and staff structure and uses “Veritas Board & Staff” pages; the public materials emphasize mentorship, virtue, and modeling of character through faculty, and the staff are described as part of a broader mission to form students within a biblical framework. The public materials present teachers as agents within a “living curriculum” frame, though that framing is not always explicitly labeled in the site copy. - The Volunteer Handbook and Parent-Student Handbook present explicit expectations for teacher/administrator virtue, the role of teachers in shaping culture, and a formalized approach to teacher/parent collaboration. The school’s materials reflect a principled view of faculty as mentors and role

models within a Christian educational framework, even if not every statement uses the exact phrase “living curriculum.”

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors; faculty as core of the school; board/staff alignment with mission; living curriculum (conceptually present in board/staff messaging); portrait or profile of instructor expected behavior (implied by a stated mission and mission-related materials). - Negative keywords: Explicit phrases like “living curriculum” or a formal, published faculty portrait are not consistently foregrounded in public copy; the precise phrasing is not always used, though the concept is present.

Why this rating - There are clear signals of faculty as core to the school’s identity and mission, with board/staff involvement and mentor-like expectations. However, the explicit articulation of the faculty as “the living curriculum” or formalized “portrait of teacher” language is not consistently spelled out in public copy, which places Element 5 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Board/Staff pages, mission language about virtue and mentorship, and governance materials.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials foreground a strong partnership with families, with explicit “In loco parentis” framing and parental authority as central to the education process; enrollment and parental agreements emphasize family involvement, accountability, and collaboration with the school. The Parent-Student Handbook and related documents present parents as co-teachers with the school and provide avenues for family involvement and school visits. - There is active emphasis on parental engagement, book-study style gatherings, and events (e.g., BBQ, family visits) that reflect a sustained community orientation. Public materials also show an admissions model that centers parental testimony and a parental/in loco parentis framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-educators; parental involvement; in loco parentis; parental contract; family engagement; school visits welcome; parent-student handbook. - Negative keywords: None evident in public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The school markets a robust, explicit partnership with parents and a vision of parents as co-educators, consistent with classical education philosophy. Public materials consistently highlight family involvement and a shared mission with parents, marking Element 6 as CLASSICAL.

Citations: Parent/Family partnership language and in loco parentis framing in mission and parent handbook materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Introduce explicit Great Books / Great Conversation language and reading lists on public pages, with a short, concrete Great Books list and clear references to reading heritage (e.g., primary sources, foundational texts). This would raise the category from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL by foregrounding the Great Books dimension more directly.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a concise “Living Curriculum” statement and a short faculty profile that explicitly positions teachers as the core curricular agents, models of virtue, and mentors. This would push Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): If feasible within K–8, articulate a plan for more explicit Socratic-style discussion or seminar-type activities appropriate to upper elementary grades (or clearly articulate a path to Socratic pedagogy in high school if/when added). Even if not currently in place, signaling a plan would strengthen the pedagogy category.
- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 6 (Parents & Community): Consider adding sanctioned liturgical or communal practices (e.g., regular chapel, collective prayer, or liturgical

music moments) described in public materials to better align with liturgical signals in the Six Elements framework.

- All relevant: Provide a short, explicit alignment map between the school's stated practices and the Positive Keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements document (e.g., a one-page rubric mapping "Christ-centered," "Truth/Goodness/Beauty," "Great Books," etc., to school practices). This would increase transparency and strengthen the overall CLASSICAL signal.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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